

The Earth's structure

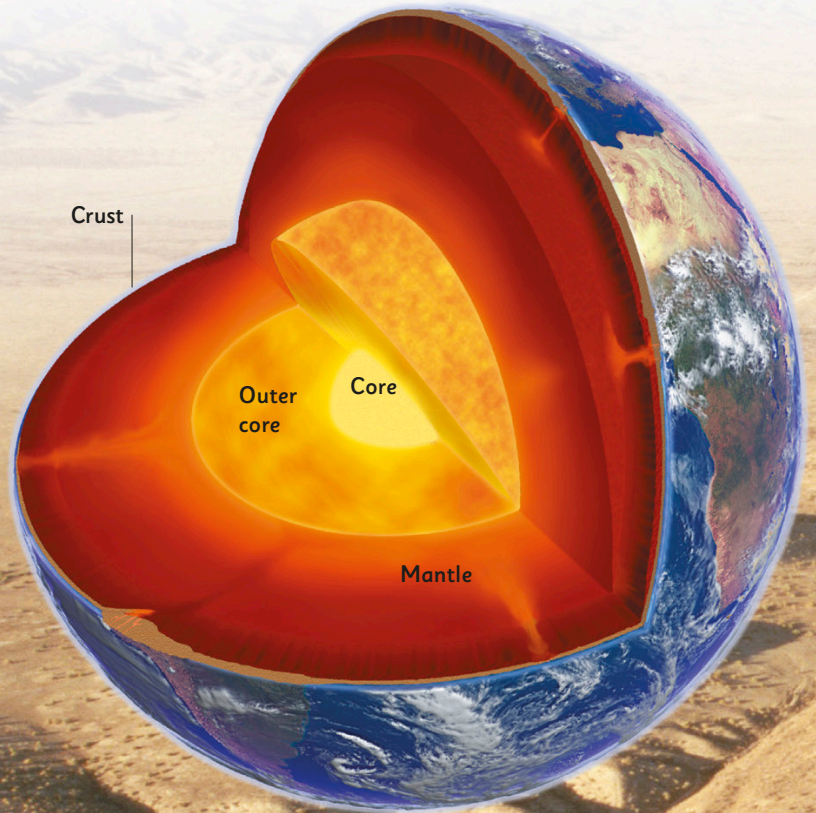


Seen from space, the Earth is a mass of blue oceans and swirling clouds.

The Earth is the only planet in the solar system that can support life because it's just the right distance from the Sun. Our amazing world is a huge ball of liquid rock with a solid surface.

Inside the Earth

If you could cut the Earth open, you'd see it's made up of layers. The thin top layer, where we live, is called the crust. Underneath is a layer of syruplike rock called the mantle, then an outer core of molten (liquid) iron and nickel. At the center is a solid iron-and-nickel core.



Life-support systems

The Earth's atmosphere and its surface water play an important role in supporting life. They help keep our planet at just the right temperature by absorbing the Sun's heat and moving it around the world.

